

APRIL 2026

PHI SIGMA RHO

ALUMNI NEWSLETTER

YOUR PERIODIC DOSE OF NEWS FROM
PHI SIGMA RHOS'S UF TAU CHAPTER

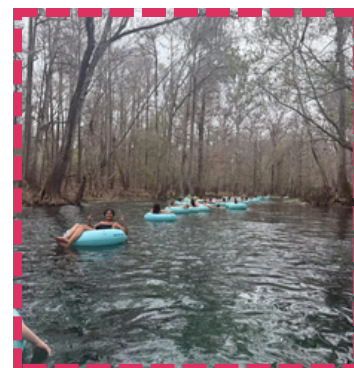


2026 Sisterhood Retreat



This semester, Sisterhood Chairs Avalee Demidovich and Natalie Rhoads brought the chapter together for a memorable cabin retreat at Camp Kulaqua, designed to deepen connections and create meaningful shared experiences.

More than 50 sisters attended—over half from the new member class—filling three cabins and spending the weekend enjoying a cozy movie night, cutesy crafts, and a refreshing trip to Ichetucknee Springs. The retreat offered the perfect balance of relaxation, fun, and genuine bonding.



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When reflecting on the planning process, Avalee and Natalie shared that the biggest challenge was “finding a nice place to accommodate everyone within the budget.” Despite this, their attention to detail made all the difference. “We prepped each cabin with snacks and water, got extra blankets and sheets, and even secured an additional smaller cabin to help distribute meals,” they said.

Their effort showed in every aspect of the weekend, creating a welcoming, thoughtful environment where sisters could connect. The retreat was ultimately a huge success, strengthening the bond within the Tau chapter of Phi Sigma Rho and leaving everyone with lasting memories

Alumni Spotlight

Heather Bray, Alpha Delta Class

Like many engineers, Heather Bray didn't always picture herself in engineering. She originally planned to pursue a career in orthodontics, but her mom—an industrial engineer—encouraged her to consider engineering instead. With her strengths in math and problem solving, the path turned out to be the perfect fit.

Today, Heather works as a Logistics Engineer at NASA on the Exploration Ground Systems Program, supporting the broader Artemis mission. In her role, she coordinates the transportation of materials between Kennedy Space Center in Florida and Naval Base San Diego, where capsule recovery operations take place. She has even traveled to California to assist in training teams preparing for capsule recovery missions.



During her time at the University of Florida, Heather joined Phi Sigma Rho in spring 2019 as part of the Alpha Delta class. She served as Power Penguin and VP of Social, and reflects on her time in Phi Rho as the place where she found a strong sense of community during college.

After graduating, Heather transitioned straight into her career at NASA following a logistics internship with the agency. Since then, her work has opened doors to unique opportunities.

From collaborating with recovery teams to meeting and guiding employees from the European Space Agency (ESA) during their visit to the base—an experience that allowed her to hear firsthand about international perspectives in space exploration.

While she loves the work she does, Heather lives by a simple motto: she works to live. For her, a fulfilling career is one that supports the life she wants to build outside of work—allowing her to pursue passions, explore new experiences, and enjoy the journey along the way.

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Penguin Fact:

Penguins have solid bones, unlike other bird species that have hollow bones. This is to help them sink and dive through the water!

<https://www.chimuadventures.com/en-us/blog/15-fun-facts-about-penguinst>